

DON'T GET

SCAMMED

CURRENT TRENDS IN

COMMERCIAL CRIMES

Stay Informed.
Stay Alert.
Stay Protected.

POLIS DIRAJA MALAYSIA

UTP

UNIVERSITI TEKNOLOGI PETRONAS

This module is the result of a collaborative initiative between the Royal Malaysia Police and Universiti Teknologi PETRONAS, developed with a shared commitment to raising awareness and educating the public on online scams. We extend our deepest appreciation to all contributors whose expertise and dedication have made this joint effort a success.

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Overview of Commercial Crimes

Commercial crimes are non-violent offences committed for financial gain, typically involving deceit, fraud, or breaches of trust. These crimes aim to exploit individuals, businesses, or governments for monetary benefit and are often subtle, making them harder to detect. Common examples include phishing, identity theft and online fraud, where criminals use digital platforms to steal money or sensitive information.

As technology advances, these crimes have become more sophisticated and difficult to trace. The global nature of the internet allows criminals to operate across borders, which complicates efforts by law enforcement agencies to track and prosecute offenders. For agencies such as the Royal Malaysia Police (PDRM), combating such cybercrimes demands substantial resources and specialised expertise in cybersecurity, as financial fraud continues to rise and become increasingly complex.



Importance of Awareness



Prevention: Recognise signs of scams to avoid becoming a victim.



Early Detection: Identify suspicious activities early for quicker reporting.



Empowerment: Take control of financial security through informed decisions.



Support for Law Enforcement: Provide accurate information to aid investigations.



Reducing Impact: Respond quickly to minimise damage when a crime occurs.

Types of Commercial Crime

01 Mule Account

02 Phone Scam

03 Love Scam

04 E-Commerce Fraud (Online Shopping Fraud)

05 Phishing (Malware Link)

06 Business Email Compromise (BEC)

07 TAC Number Fraud

08 Loan Scam

09 Investment Scam

10 Illegal Money Lending

11 Counterfeit Money

12 Cryptocurrency Crime

13 Job Scam

Mule Account

Description

Individuals who provide their Automated Teller Machine (ATM) cards and PIN numbers to others, resulting in the misuse of their bank accounts for criminal activities.

Handing over ATM cards:

- The account owner hands over the ATM card and pin number or online banking password to a friend, online contact, or any person who has no legal rights for use without the account owner's own monitoring.



Selling/ renting ATM cards:

- The account owner gets paid when they rent or sell the ATM card and PIN number or online banking password to a third party.

Job offers to perform transactions:

- The account owner receives a commission for transferring funds from a private account to a third-party account.



- The victim transfers the funds to a primary mule account designated by the suspect or syndicate.
- The funds are swiftly move from the primary mule account through multiple layers of additional mule accounts.
- The syndicate then disburses the fraudulent proceeds to erase any trace of the funds within the banking system.

Legal Implications

1. SECTION 424 OF THE PENAL CODE:

- Addresses fraudulently taking away property or using deceit to conceal it. This includes actions where someone dishonestly removes, transfers, or conceals any property.

2. SECTION 424A OF THE PENAL CODE:

- Pertains to owning or controlling of payment instrument or bank account that belongs to someone else without legal authorization or means.

3. SECTION 424B OF THE PENAL CODE:

- Addresses the act of giving or handing over ownership or control of payment instrument or bank account to someone else without legal authorization or means.

4. SECTION 424C OF THE PENAL CODE:

- Pertain to a person who involves in any transactions using payment instrument or bank account without legal authorization or means.





Prevention Tips

- **DO NOT** share banking information.
- **BEWARE** of impersonation.
- **NEVER** lend or sell your bank account/card — even to friends or "agents."
- **AVOID** job offers promising easy money for using your account.
- Be **WARY** of strangers asking to transfer money through you.
- **REMEMBER:** Letting others use your account for scams is a crime.

Phone Scam



Description

Fraudsters impersonate authorities or institutions to deceive victims.

Modus Operandi

Fake calls from "authorities" that demands for bank details, and threats of arrest:

- Suspects contact victims by posing as law enforcement, financial institutions or service companies: Polis, Bank, TM, LHDM, etc.
- The victim is falsely accused of being involved in a criminal case or having outstanding bank loans, tax debts, or similar liabilities.
- Threats of arrest and prosecution are used to intimidate the victim.
- The victim is explicitly instructed not to disclose the situation to anyone.
- Under the guise of facilitating an investigation, the suspect demands that the victim provide banking details or transfer funds to an unverified bank account.

Submitting ATM card:

- The victim was instructed to leave their ATM card in designated areas without CCTV surveillance.

Prevention Tips

- **NEVER** hesitate to inform your bank about any suspicious activity.
- **REFER** to the nearest police station.



Love Scam



Description

Deception through romantic relationships formed online.

Modus Operandi

Acquainted:

- The victim and suspect initially connected through social media, where the suspect impersonated various professionals, such as oil and gas engineers, traders, pilots or soldiers.
- Using charming words, the suspect made the victim feel as though they were in love.
- The suspect then manipulated the victim with various deceptive reasons, including:
    1. Presenting gifts.
    2. Requesting investments in businesses.
    3. Claiming a need for a testament.
    4. Asking for funds to cover hospital expenses.

Ask for payment:

- Once the victim feels emotionally attached, the scammer begins to ask for financial help, often claiming to face an urgent problem.
- For example, the scammer might say they need money for a medical emergency, travel expenses to visit the victim, or to release a shipment stuck in customs.
- Believing the relationship is genuine, the victim transfers the money as requested.
- After receiving the funds, the scammer continues to make new excuses and requests for more money.
- Eventually, when the victim becomes suspicious or refuses to send further payments, the scammer uses compromising photos of the victim to blackmails or extorts more money.

Prevention Tips

- **DO NOT** engage with individuals you don't know on social media.
- **NEVER** trust people you meet on social media too quickly.
- Before completing any transaction, **CONSULT** the appropriate party or agency.
- **DO NOT** believe offers that seem
- "too good to be true."

LATEST NEWS

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NEWS MALAYSIA SINGAPORE MONEY WORLD LIFE EATSDRINK SHOWBIZ OPINI

MALAYSIA

Perak lawyer loses heart and wallet to fake marine geologist in RM1.75m love scam

E-Commerce Fraud

Description

Scams involving buying or selling goods online.

Modus Operandi

Victims as Buyers:

- The victim came across an online sales advertisement posted by the suspect.
- The suspect offered prices significantly lower than market rates to entice the victim.
- The victim was instructed to transfer money immediately to a bank account provided by the suspect.
- Unfortunately, the victim failed to verify the legitimacy of the seller and did not receive the goods as promised.

Victims as a Seller:

- After contacting the victim, the suspect expressed interest in purchasing some of the merchandise.
- The suspect falsely claimed to have accidentally transferred an incorrect amount and asked the victim to return the excess funds.
- To support this claim, the suspect provided a counterfeit transaction receipt. Furthermore, the suspect threatened to file a police report if the victim refused to return the supposed excess money.

Prevention Tips

- Be **CAUTIOUS** of offers that seem too good to be true.
- Always **VERIFY** bank account details and phone numbers.
- Shop **ONLY** from trusted websites with proper security features.
- **CHECK** reviews and feedback from other buyers.
- **AVOID** transactions outside the platform or via private messages (PM).
- **IF** the bank account number belongs to a third party, most likely it is a mule account and it is a scam.



Current Trends

Foreign Recon Cars:

- View advertisements on social media.
- Deal exclusively online.
- Requested payment for wages, customs, transportation, etc.

Gold Scam:

- View advertisements on social media.
- Deal exclusively online.
- Asked for payment to be made to the mule account.



Phishing



Description

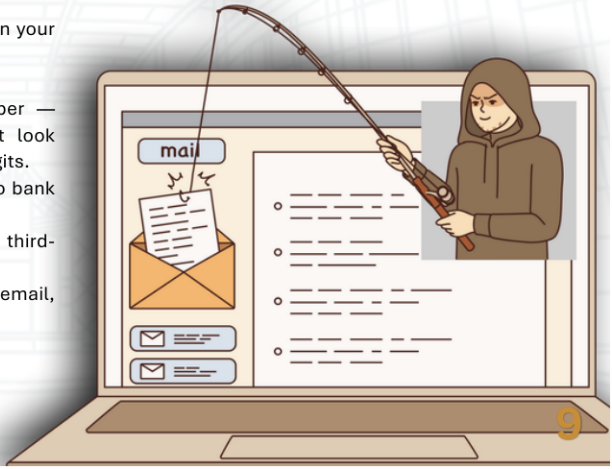
Fraudsters impersonate authorities or institutions to deceive victims.

Modus Operandi

- Scammers may send emails or SMS messages with links to fake bank or business websites, using various tricks to deceive victims: Claiming victims need to update their bank accounts.
- Asking victims to provide banking details for investigation purposes (e.g., Phone Scam). Announcing that victims have won a prize or are eligible for financial support.
- Requiring victims to download an app (APK file) for payment or service access.
- Victims unknowingly log into these fake websites with their user ID and password, granting scammers access to their online banking credentials.

Prevention Tips

- **DO NOT** click on suspicious links, verify the address of the banking website is accurate.
- **SAVE** the banking website's URL to a bookmark in your web browser.
- **BEWARE** of fake apps.
- **CHECK** the sender's address or phone number — scammers often use emails or numbers that look similar to official ones but have extra letters or digits.
- **DO NOT** share your TAC, OTP, or password — no bank or government agency will ever ask for these.
- **AVOID** logging in through pop-up windows or third-party links.
- **USE** multi-factor authentication (MFA) on your email, banking, and social media accounts.



Current Trends

Bank Account Update

- The victim allegedly received an SMS from the bank requesting that he update his bank account.
- The victim is requested to click the SMS link.
- After being directed to a phony banking website, the victim inputs their ID and password.
- A suspect posing as the bank contacted the victim and requested the TAC number.
- The victim's bank account funds were moved to another account without the victim's knowledge.

Win Prizes or Help

- Victims receive SMS to receive financial assistance or gifts.
- The victim is asked to press the link on the SMS.
- The victim is taken to a fake company website.
- The victim is asked to enter the e-wallet account pin number.
- Unbeknownst to the victim, the money in the victim's e-wallet account has been transferred.

Phone Application (Scam App)

- The victim saw an advertisement selling on social media.
- The victim contacted the suspect via WhatsApp and did not meet.
- The suspect asked the victim to download a mobile phone application (APK file) and install it on the victim's mobile phone.
- The victim goes to a fake banking website and enters the victim's bank account / credit card information.
- An error page is displayed. Unbeknownst to the victim, the money in the victim's bank account was transferred to an unknown account.



Business Email Compromise

Description

Fraud involving email impersonation between business partners.

Modus Operandi

- Company A and Company B are business partners who often communicate through email.
- One day, Company A receives an email that looks like it came from Company B, asking for future payments to be made to a new bank account. However, the email is actually from a scammer using a fake address that looks very similar to Company B's real one.
- Company A does not notice the small difference in the email address and transfers the money to the scammer's account.
- Later, when Company B asks about the missing payment, Company A realises it has been tricked by a business email compromise scam.

Prevention Tips

- DO NOT click on links in emails from unknown sources.
- VERIFY email addresses carefully.
- CONTACT the business partner by phone to confirm the account change.





TAC Number Fraud

Description

Scammer asking for TAC (Transaction Authorization Code) numbers under false pretenses.

Modus Operandi

Posing as bank representatives needing the TAC for corrections.

Prevention Tips

- **DO NOT** share bank security numbers or TAC.
- **CONTACT** your bank immediately if you suspect fraudulent activity.
- **IGNORE** SMS or WhatsApp from unknown people.



Loan Scam



Description

Offers of non-existent loans, requiring advance payments.

Modus Operandi

- Suspects use SMS, social media, and print media to advertise money loans.
- The victim has never met the suspect and only transacts over the phone or via WhatsApp.
- The suspect typically presents a phony SSM certificate and has no office.
- The victim must deposit money into the mule's bank account for several expenses, including bail, stamp duty, insurance, and legal costs.
- After that, the suspect vanished and was never heard from again.



Prevention Tips

- Conduct transactions at the lender's office and **VERIFY** licenses.
- **CHECK** licenses or company names with the Ministry of Housing and Local Government of Malaysia.

Investment Scam

Description

Scammers lure victims with promises of high returns and low risk. Once the money is invested, they disappear, leaving the victim with losses.

Modus Operandi

- Scammers offer attractive investment schemes promising high returns in a short time.
- Victims are asked to transfer money to the scammer's account and may receive small initial profits as bait.
- Later, they are told to invest more or pay extra fees to claim their profits.
- In the end, the profits never arrive, and the scammer disappears with the money.

Prevention Tips

- Be **CAUTIOUS** of investment offers that promise high returns with little or no risk.
- **RESEARCH** the company or platform before investing — verify its registration and track record.
- **AVOID** dealing directly with individuals you meet on social media or messaging apps.
- **DO NOT** transfer money to personal bank accounts or unknown third parties.
- Be **WARY** of pressure tactics or offers that sound "too good to be true."
- **CHECK** official sources, such as financial regulators or the police, for scam alerts.
- **KEEP** records of all communications and transactions.
- If in doubt, **SEEK** advice from trusted financial institutions or authorities before investing.





Illegal Money Lending

Description

Loan sharks offering high-interest loans and using threats or violence for repayment.

Modus Operandi

- Operating without a Ministry of Housing and Local Government of Malaysia's license.
- Providing quick, simple, and unsecured loans.
- Offers easy loans without any documents and hassle free

Current Trends (e-AHLONG)

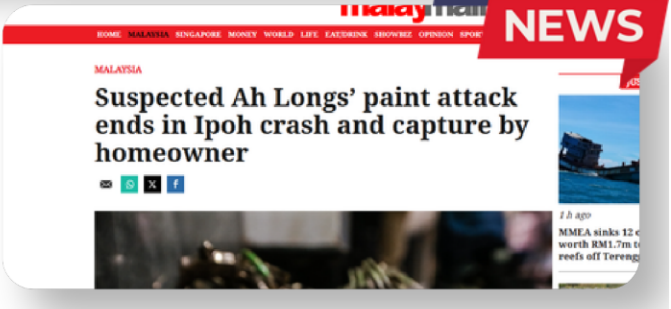
- The application for a loan will request authorization to access the borrower's mobile phone data. AH LONG will intimidate and harass borrowers or contacts using data like images, videos, and borrower contacts.

Prevention Tips

- **REPORT** illegal lenders to the authorities.
- **EDUCATE** yourself on the signs of illegal money lending practices.
- When downloading apps to mobile devices, exercise **CAUTION** when granting access permissions.
- If you have any suspicions, **REMOVE** the application right away.



LATEST NEWS



Counterfeit

Description

Circulation of counterfeit money and its impact on the economy.

Modus Operandi

- Victims advertise items for sale on social media.
- Scammers pose as buyers and contact the victims to purchase the items.
- The scammers insist on paying in cash or using COD (cash on delivery).
- They arrange to meet in a poorly lit or suspicious location.
- During the exchange, the scammers pay quickly and make excuses to leave in a hurry.
- The victims later discover that the cash is counterfeit after checking it in a well-lit area.

Prevention Tips

- **EXAMINE** banknotes carefully for security features.
- **REPORT** any counterfeit money to the police immediately.
- **REQUEST** that the buyer make **PAYMENT ONLINE**, and ensure the payment has been **RECEIVED** before delivering the item.





Crytocurrency Crime

Description

Fraudulent activities involving digital currencies. Common schemes include fake initial coin offerings (ICOs) and investment scams.

Modus Operandi

Four Digital Exchanger (DAX) companies have been approved by the SC to be registered and allow the public to transact cryptocurrency in Malaysia; LUNO Malaysia SDN BHD, SINEGY Technologies (M) SDN BHD, TOKENIZE Technology (M) SDN BHD, and MX GLOBAL SDN BHD.

Crimes involving Cryptocurrency:

- Investment Scams.
- Cryptocurrency trading scam.
- Mule cryptocurrency account.
- Cryptocurrency wallet hacking.
- DAX Hacking.
- The crime of extortion.



Prevention Tips

- Use **REPUTABLE** exchanges and wallets for cryptocurrency transactions.
- **ENABLE** two-factor authentication for added security.
- For any **HELP** and **ADVICE** related to crime involving cryptocurrencies, **CONTACT** kppforensikjsjk@rmp.gov.my (Unit Siasatan Jenayah Cryptocurrency Jabatan Siasatan Jenayah Komersil Polis Diraja Malaysia)

LATEST NEWS

Bukit Aman: Perak cops arrest 11 suspected crypto investment scammers in hotel raid



1 h ago

MMEA sinks 12 worth RM1.7m reefs off Tereng

Job Scam

Description

Scammers pose as employers or recruiters, offering fake job opportunities to collect personal information or upfront payments for training or processing fees. Once the money or details are given, the offer disappears.

Modus Operandi

- Scammers post fake job advertisements on social media, job portals, or messaging apps, offering high salaries and easy work to attract victims.
- Once the victim shows interest, the scammer poses as a recruiter or company representative and requests personal information such as identification documents or bank details.
- The victim is then asked to pay various fees — such as for registration, training, or work equipment — with the promise that these costs will be reimbursed later.
- After the payment is made, communication suddenly stops, and the advertised job turns out to be non-existent.

Open a new bank account:

- The scammer instructed the victim to use a specific phone number to register and open a new bank account.
- The victim was coerced into giving their sensitive information, including their ATM card and PIN.
- The scammer are able to sign up, gain access to the victim's online banking account and obtain the Transaction Authentication Code (TAC) without the victim's knowledge or consent.
- The scammer will then used the newly opened account as a mule account.

Prevention Tips

- Be **CAUTIOUS** of job offers that promise high pay for little work.
- **VERIFY** the company's details through its official website or trusted sources before applying.
- **NEVER** pay for job applications, training, or equipment upfront.
- **AVOID** sharing personal or banking information with unknown recruiters.
- **CHECK** the email domain — legitimate companies usually use official business addresses, not free email accounts.
- Be **WARY** of recruiters who rush you to decide or communicate only through messaging apps.
- **REPORT** suspicious job adverts to the authorities or job portal administrators.

LATEST NEWS


MALAYSIA

Cops bust job scam ring in Ipoh bungalow, 12 arrested in call centre targeting Chinese victims

12 h ago

MMEA sinks 12 con... boats worth RM1.7... artificial reefs off I...



Legal Implications

1. SECTION 109 OF THE PENAL CODE:
- This section addresses the abetment of any offense, where a person assists or is involved in committing the crime.

2. SECTION 120B OF THE PENAL CODE:
- Pertains to criminal conspiracy. This section deals with any agreement between two or more people to commit a crime.

3. SECTION 137 OF THE FINANCIAL SERVICES ACT:
- Prohibits unauthorized acceptance of deposits. It is illegal to accept deposits from the public without proper licensing or authorization.

4. SECTION 411 OF THE PENAL CODE:
- Relates to dishonestly receiving stolen property. This section deals with situations where a person knowingly receives or retains property obtained through theft.

5. SECTION 420 OF THE PENAL CODE:
- Deals with cheating and dishonestly inducing the delivery of property. It applies when someone deceives another person, resulting in the wrongful delivery of property.



Importance of Vigilance



WARNING!!!
The offences above, if found guilty, may result in imprisonment, a fine, or both.

Vigilance is crucial in combating increasingly complex commercial crimes driven by technological advancements and global connectivity. Staying alert helps individuals and organisations detect fraud, scams, and other illicit activities early, allowing swift action to minimise financial losses and prevent further harm. By recognising suspicious behaviour, people can make safer financial decisions and report crimes promptly.

Without vigilance, fraudsters can more easily exploit victims, creating ongoing cycles of financial crime. As scams such as phishing and identity theft become more sophisticated, proactive awareness and strong security measures are essential defences against falling victim, helping to build a safer financial environment for all.

National Scam Response Centre (NSRC)

Description

NSRC is a response centre that combines National Anti-Financial Crime Centre (NFCC), Royal Malaysian Police (PDRM), Central Bank of Malaysia (BNM), Malaysia Communications and Multimedia Commission (MCMC), together with financial institutions and telecommunication services.

Golden Hours

Report your incident within 24 Hours

Hotline - 997

Operates 24 hours daily

Are you a victim of a scam?

Quickly notify your bank operator or NSRC to block all of your transactions.

What information should you provide?

- The incident of the scam.
- The suspect that you communicate with.
- Your recent transactions.



OFFICIAL CHANNELS
Be Smart, Stay Alert

Call 997 : National Scam Response Centre (NSRC)

Website: semakmule@rmp.gov.my
To verify the account number, telephone number and company name.

Social media: @JSJKPDRM
Facebook, Tiktok & Instagram:
To obtain the latest commercial crime information.

Disclaimer :

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